

Yes, `router.back()` is generally equivalent to clicking the browser's back button. In most modern web frameworks (like Next.js, React Router, or Angular), this method programmatically triggers the same action as the browser's native back functionality. 🍌 Stack Overflow +3

Key Similarities and Behaviors

- **Session History:** It moves back one entry in the [browser's session history](#).
- **Effect:** Calling `router.back()` is functionally the same as executing `window.history.back()` or `history.go(-1)` in standard JavaScript.
- **No History:** If there is no previous page in the session history (e.g., the user opened the link in a new tab), calling this method typically does nothing. 🍌 Medium · Alexander Nicholson +1

Important Nuances

While they perform the same action, there are technical differences in how developers interact with them: 🔗

- **Custom Logic:** Unlike the native browser button, a custom button using `router.back()` can be wrapped in additional logic, such as saving state or showing a [confirmation modal](#) before navigating.
- **Event Handling:** Frameworks often use the `popstate` event to detect when the browser's back button is clicked so they can synchronize the application's internal state with the URL.
- **Platform Specifics:** In mobile-focused environments like [Expo Router](#) (React Native), `router.back()` pops the current screen off the navigation stack, which mimics the behavior of the native hardware back button on Android or the swipe-back gesture on iOS. 🍌 YouTube · Cand Dev +4